

# Murder Mystery

*Dinner Party 2026*

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## Anya Tique

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*The Meridian Museum*

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

# INTRODUCTIONS



**Anya Tique**

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## *Founding Curator Emerita*

Anya remembers when the museum was two rooms and an argument. Anya helped build the Meridian's collection when the museum had more ambition than money and fewer committees than fire extinguishers.

- Hired **Artie Ficial** early in his career.
- Trusts **Chip Patina** and **Anne E. Dote**.
- Has known **Tess Tament** since **Tess** was a child.

## **ACTING TIPS**

Imperious, funny, observant, utterly unimpressed by status. Age gives you permission to say what everyone else edits.

## **YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD**

I'm Anya Tique. I helped build this museum. Tonight I reserve the right to judge the lighting and everyone in it.

*Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.*

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Anya Tique

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## Behind the portrait

### Your grievance with Grant

Grant planned to reveal that you accepted his first questionable donation in 1989 despite incomplete paperwork, staining the legacy you built.

### Your other secret

You did approve that accession because the museum was desperate for funds and you convinced yourself the paperwork would follow.

### Conversations to start

- Ask Artie Ficial whether the naming agreement preserves the museum you founded.
- Ask Tess Tament what she thinks Grant expects from his family tonight.

*One attending guest committed the murder alone. Follow your printed account during the hearings. If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else.*

By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don't share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.  
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Anya Tique

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# The game is afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

- 1 *Where fingers conduct a row of musical keys, a clue waits underneath.*
- 2 *Behind a crimson curtain, the museum has misplaced a document.*
- 3 *The clue has chosen the place where ice cream refuses to melt.*



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.  
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



**Anya Tique**

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## Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament**

What did Grant demand from you, and what had you already concealed?

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**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir**

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

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**Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid**

What hidden transaction made Grant a threat to you?

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**Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions**

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

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**Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme**

What truth did Grant want suppressed, and what could embarrass you?

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**Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop**

What did Grant ask you to hide?

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**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist**

What compromise in your work gave Grant leverage over you?

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**Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks**

What did you want returned or protected?

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**Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What past agreement was about to become a public dispute?

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**Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote**

How did Grant threaten your work, and how did you respond?

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*Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.*

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Anya Tique

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### Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.  
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

#### IF INNOCENT

In 1989 I accepted Grant's donation with papers still missing. The museum needed money, and I believed his promise that they would follow. I had built part of this institution on that promise. Tonight he wanted my old signature treated as permission to do it again. I was ashamed of the first decision and angry at what he thought it entitled him to.

#### IF MURDERER

In 1989 I accepted Grant's donation with papers still missing. The museum needed money, and I believed his promise that they would follow. I had built part of this institution on that promise. Tonight he wanted my old signature treated as permission to do it again. I could not accept that this was what the museum I helped found had become.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**  
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**





**Anya Tique**

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### Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Paige Turner / Justin Tyme**

What task or errand occupied you before the toast?

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**Claire O'Scuro / Vincent Van Faux / Saul D. Bid**

How did you approach Grant about your papers or work?

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**Hugh Bidder / Tess Tament / Anya Tique / Ella Gance**

When did you first enter, and what business did you have with Grant?

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**Monet Bags / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks**

Describe your errand at the private service station.

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**Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates**

What physical work or problem occupied you?

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**Dada DiCapo / Dr. Art E. Fact / Elon Mosaic**

What did Grant want changed, and how did you respond before the toast?

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**Sue Venir / Elle Loominate / Reed DeLabel**

Why did you contact the preparation department, and how did you collect your papers?

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**Barb Dwyer / Frank Lloyd Wrong / Minnie Malist**

What practical museum duty were you handling?

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**Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Penny Pincher**

What did you bring Grant, and what happened when you delivered it?

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**Anne E. Dote / Faye Stop**

How did your museum materials bring you through the preparation department?

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*Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.*

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Anya Tique

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### Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.  
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

#### IF INNOCENT

I went to the accession drawer and replaced the exhibition copy of the 1989 record with a photocopy that left out my handwritten exception. I had accepted incomplete papers then and was concealing that compromise again. Grant found the original entry and asked whether I remembered signing it. I did. I took the photocopy back out of the drawer. The original register was still there when the archivist checked it.

#### IF MURDERER

I went to the accession drawer and replaced the exhibition copy of the 1989 record with a photocopy that left out my handwritten exception. I had accepted incomplete papers then and was concealing that compromise again. Grant found the original entry and asked whether I remembered signing it. I did. I took the photocopy back out of the drawer. The original register was still there when the archivist checked it.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**  
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**





**Anya Tique**

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# Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

**Claire O'Scuro / Sue Venir / Dr. Art E. Fact**

What detail on your paperwork or its packaging should we notice?

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**Artie Ficial / Tess Tament / Minnie Malist**

What did you handle around the speech or service preparations?

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**Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid**

What original record or material completes your account of the dispute?

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**Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates**

Which retained record or material explains the work or problem you described?

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**Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Elle Loominate**

What physical detail completes your account of the work you wanted protected?

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**Monet Bags / Anya Tique / Penny Pincher**

What was on the material you brought, and what does it actually record?

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**Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks**

What did your access or service arrangements actually involve?

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**Paige Turner / Drew Conclusions / Faye Stop**

Which original or retained material did you handle, and what marks does it bear?

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**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Reed DeLabel / Anne E. Dote**

What does the completed work or return record tell us?

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**Mona Lott / Ella Gance / Justin Tyme**

What retained paper or record supports your account, and what does it disclose?

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*Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.*

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Anya Tique

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# Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.  
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

The staffed entrance admitted me for the first time at 6:30. The staffed guest book records the first admission I described. My signature on the accession shows that I accepted an incomplete file. It does not make the promised export document exist.

## IF MURDERER

The staffed entrance admitted me for the first time at 6:16. The staffed guest book documents the first admission I described. My signature on the accession shows that I accepted an incomplete file. It does not make the promised export document exist. The inventory records a foil-backed red scrap caught in my accession file. I carried that through the walkthrough and to Grant's table. I moved his glass before putting down the accession record.

*The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.*



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.  
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Anya Tique

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# Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

**Your character name**

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**I accuse**

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**Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction**

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**Best Actor**

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**Best Costume**

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Anya Tique

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## The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

### IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I accepted the incomplete file in 1989 and concealed my exception again tonight. The archivist retained the original register. I first entered at 6:30, after the bottle was locked away. I did not kill Grant. I will restore the complete accession record, including my own handwriting, and stop treating promised papers as papers received.

### IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I took cyanide during the preparation walkthrough. While the glass was uncovered, I used it to poison Grant's glass during that visit. A piece of the bottle seal caught in my accession file when I opened it. I carried it to the table without noticing; another fragment landed in the glass. The inventory and laboratory comparison exposed that connection. The old accession file could disgrace me. I killed Grant before he could use it in front of the donors.

*Every selected suspect gets their final word.*